

AUTOMOBILES AS A KEY CONSUMER OF ELECTRONICS

The automobile industry is using electronics at a furious pace. By the estimate of some popular subject bloggers, a high-end car might use around 70-100 intelligent chips! In fact, even 8-bit and 16-bit microcontrollers do not suffice the needs of today's vehicles and the industry uses 32-bit ones.

Electronics play a huge role in automobiles – to monitor emission and other such factors subject to environmental regulations, for safety control, and infotainment.

High-end control systems are used to boost performance and energy regeneration efficiency of batteries; sensors are used to monitor emission; radio frequency identification (RFID) tags are used to identify spare parts and track their age; sensors are used to keep tab of the temperature of vital parts such as the engine and tyres; the convergence of video, audio and data is used to entertain the user as well as to provide information updates; mobile technologies are playing a huge role in 'connecting' the vehicle with the outside world; navigation systems ensure the automobile is on the right track at all times; geographical positioning systems (GPS) help keep track of the position and speed of vehicles—a boon for logistics firms; other electronic systems are used for remote diagnostics, vehicle immobilisation systems, collision detection, etc. In such and many more ways, electronics is playing a huge role in vehicles.

The in-car display that will soon be a part of the dashboard of most cars will be the symbol of the 'connected' car. It will be the interface through



which the driver interacts with all the electronic systems mentioned above. Experts say it will also play a key role in connecting the car with the Internet and other consumer electronics used at home, at work, and on-the-go. ●

The author is a freelance writer based in Bengaluru. She writes on a variety of topics, her favourites being technology, cuisine, and life

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